apparently prefer living in Israel to eventually becoming citizens of a hypothetical Palestinian state. A complicated situation, to say the least.

Wednesday, June 7

Today, in an aggressive speech to the Knesset, Levin gave the expected indication that he won't convene the Judicial Selection Committee. How long, Levin, will you abuse our patience? But it may be his swan song. On June 14, the Knesset has to vote on the composition of the committee: if it sticks with the usual formula of adding one candidate from the coalition and one from the opposition, then Levin's overhaul is dead.

It so happens that, as I am writing this, I am reading Ulrich Boschwitz's novel *The Passenger* about the travails of a Jew in German society on and after Kristallnacht. It is astonishingly gripping, even for somebody whose life's work has been studying and writing about these events and beyond. When, these days, I reflect on even the prewar Nazi years, I cannot help cringing, on the one hand, at the pettiness of our ongoing debates and, on the other, being taken aback by the blindness and ignorance of part of our present generation of Israelis regarding the meaning and consequences of a country's eliminating its independent justice system, in an atmosphere of political aggressiveness and ideological fanaticism.

Actually, pettiness is not the right word. Of course, every political debate is petty when compared to the issues of life and death confronting the Jews during the Nazi years, but fighting for democracy is certainly not petty and fighting for a society that refuses to submit to religious domination is far from being petty. Never mind the right word—the idea should hopefully be clear.

Two days ago, Iran unveiled what it claimed to be its first hypersonic ballistic missile, capable of reaching Israel.